QUICK GUIDE

# MIDRANGE VOCAL SEPARATION

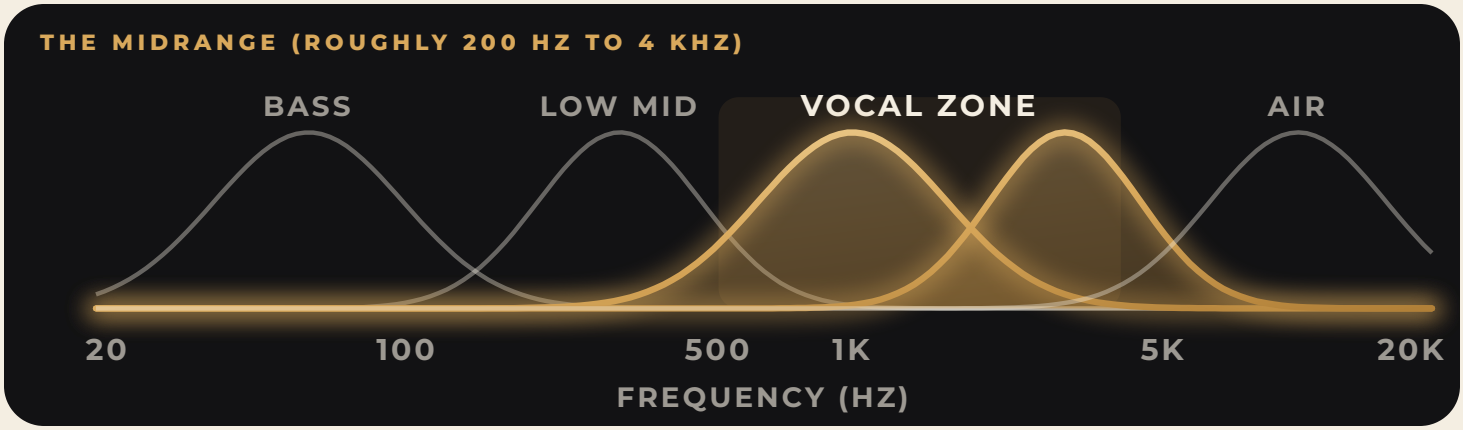
What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

## WHAT IT IS

The midrange is the part of the spectrum, roughly 200 Hz to 4 kHz, where vocals, guitars, synths and snares all live. Vocal separation means making room there so the voice stays clear.

## HOW IT SOUNDS

Clear and forward when it's right. Boxy, muddy or buried when it isn't.




01

### LOW MIDS ADD BODY

Roughly 200 to 500 Hz. Too much sounds boxy or muddy.

02

### MIDS CARRY THE VOCAL

Roughly 500 Hz to 2 kHz. This is where the words live.

03

### UPPER MIDS ADD CLARITY

Roughly 2 to 4 kHz. A small boost brings presence.

## DO THIS TONIGHT

***Cut the competing mids on the other track before you boost the vocal.***

- [ ] Find the vocal range, about 500 Hz to 4 kHz.
- [ ] Turn the mid knob down a little on the other track.
- [ ] Still hidden? Add a touch of mids to the vocal. Small moves only.



PRACTICE & CHECK

# MIDRANGE VOCAL SEPARATION: YOUR TURN

## WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Mixing an acapella over an instrumental.
- Blending two full tracks without the vocals clashing.
- Fixing a vocal that disappears when the drums come in.

## QUICK CHECK

**1. Roughly where does the midrange sit?**

**2. What do you cut first when vocals clash?**

**3. What does too much low-mid sound like?**

**Answer key:** 1) About 200 Hz to 4 kHz. 2) The competing mids on the other track. 3) Boxy or muddy.

REMEMBER

***Make room first. Boost second.***

## YOUR NOTES

**UP NEXT** Resonance Control



